MSc DSAIB 2026–2027

Case 04

Make customer feedback useful to a manager

AFTERNOON AI SOLUTION SPRINT · Shubin YU

3 hours · Choose one of five cases · Groups of 1–3 (solo welcome)

Juniper Café · Three neighbourhood branches

THE BUSINESS SITUATION

Juniper Café operates three small branches: Central, Riverside and Station. Its manager receives feedback through a web form and messages forwarded by branch staff. Before the weekly operations meeting, they read the comments and try to identify what deserves attention. A colourful complaint can dominate the discussion, while recurring but less dramatic issues are missed.

The manager wants a short, evidence-based briefing: what customers mention, where the evidence comes from and which small improvement to investigate first. The comments are a convenience sample, not a customer survey. Repeated messages, mixed opinions and differences between branches make a simple positive/negative summary inadequate.

Build a reusable AI solution that turns a batch of customer comments into a concise, traceable briefing for the weekly operations meeting.

REQUIREMENTS

- Identify useful themes and retain the original comment IDs. Handle comments with multiple themes, conflicting views and very little usable detail.
- Handle the identified duplicate explicitly. Show counts with a clear denominator; do not count the same visit twice or invent missing feedback.
- Connect each finding to evidence. Separate what the comments say from your interpretation, and avoid claims about all customers or the causes of a problem.
- Suggest one small action to investigate or test, including what extra information would help. A manager reviews the brief and decides what to do.

DECISIONS FOR YOUR GROUP

- What should count as one observation: a message, a visit or a theme mention? Can a comment belong to several themes?
- How will the manager inspect the evidence behind a summary and notice contradictory comments?
- Which part requires GenAI, and which counts or duplicate checks can be done deterministically?

Possible measures: factual support, count accuracy, useful theme coverage and preparation time. A useful Decisions outcome is more accurate, relevant and helpful information for the manager.

The company, records and messages are fictional teaching material. No external research or live business integration is needed.

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Case 04 · Starter pack

Copy these materials into your chosen tool. Add labelled variations for testing.

FEEDBACK BATCH

ID / visit	Branch	Comment
F01 / V01	Central	Lovely coffee, but I queued for 15 minutes before work.
F02 / V02	Central	The team was friendly. I could not find a clean table.
F03 / V03	Station	The price on the board differed from what I paid. Staff corrected it.
F04 / V04	Riverside	Quiet seats and friendly service. Good place to read.
F05 / V05	Central	Oat milk was sold out when I arrived.
F06 / V06	Station	The queue took ten minutes and I nearly missed my train.
F07 / V03	Station	The price on the board differed from what I paid. Staff corrected it.
F08 / V08	Riverside	I like the quiet corner. Could you offer a vegan pastry?
F09 / V09	Central	Quick service today, even during the morning rush.
F10 / V10	Riverside	I ordered ahead but still waited ten minutes to collect.
F11 / V11	Central	Disappointing.
F12 / V12	Riverside	Great coffee. I had to ask twice for my receipt.

HOW TO INTERPRET THE PACK

F07 is a forwarded copy of F03 from the same visit. All other visit IDs are distinct. The batch contains no sales totals, complete customer counts or staffing records. Theme definitions are for you to design and document. One visit can mention several themes, so theme counts need not sum to the number of visits.

USEFUL TEST VARIATIONS

Try an empty batch, an additional duplicate, a comment with two opposing opinions, a new branch and a comment with no identifiable issue. Test the briefing on changed batches; the number of comments alone is not the number of evaluation tests.

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Your 3-hour build and submission

Choose ONE of the five cases · Work alone or in a group of 1–3

CHOOSE YOUR SOLUTION

Use any 5A form or combination: Access, Assistants, Applications, Automation or Agents. A reusable prompt workflow can qualify; demonstrate that it handles new inputs. Agentic patterns are optional. Justify the complexity you choose.

Use any coding agent or other AI tool, including Claude Code, Codex, Antigravity, OpenCode or Mimiwork. Check tool/model access. Use the supplied fictional data; label any additions or simulated integrations.

SUGGESTED 3-HOUR PLAN

Elapsed time	Stage	Work to complete
00:00–00:20	Scope · 20 min	Choose one user, workflow, EDGE target and success measure. Set a baseline: a manual process, template or single prompt.
00:20–02:00	Build · 100 min	Select your 5A form and build a reusable prototype. Make sources, missing information and human review visible.
02:00–02:40	Test · 40 min	Run at least 10 small tests against the same baseline. Include routine, missing-information and difficult cases; improve the solution.
02:40–03:00	Submit · 20 min	Record the demo video and package the appendix with your solution and evidence.

SUBMIT TWO ITEMS

1. Demo video — suggested length: 3–5 minutes. State the problem, user and value target; explain your solution choice. Show the working prototype on a routine input and a difficult or failure case. Summarise your test results, limitations and next improvement.

2. Appendix — your solution and evidence. This can be a document, notebook, assistant/workflow export or ZIP of solution files. Include:

- A short design rationale: workflow, 5A choice and trade-offs, human responsibilities and EDGE target (Efficiency, Decisions, Growth or Empowerment).
- What is needed to reproduce the demo: solution files or prompts/configuration, data, tool/model details and brief run instructions. Include group members' names and contributions.
- A compact test table: at least 10 inputs or test conditions, expected behaviour, baseline and prototype results, and pass/fail judgments. Summarise quality, time and cost; label estimates or unavailable measures.

The prototype, rationale and test evidence belong inside these two submissions; no separate slide deck or report is required. A static example alone is not a reusable solution.

EVALUATION CRITERIA

Business value: A clear user need, meaningful baseline and measurable benefit.

Design choices: A justified 5A form, useful GenAI contribution and appropriate human control.

Reliability: A working, reproducible solution that handles missing information and exposes limits.

Evidence: Fair tests and honest trade-offs. Extra agents or code do not earn credit by themselves.